IGNATIUS BOOK FAIRS

VIRTUAL

VIRTUAL FAIR CHECKLIST

Your step-by-step guide to planning a successful virtual book fair

Initial Prep and Planning

- [ ] Read through and print out THE GUIDE
- [ ] Read through and print out the FAQs
- [ ] Familiarize yourself with the ADVERTISING RESOURCES
- [ ] Create an account on our website and choose the role of **Book Fair Coordinator**. Other roles can be added later. This will make it easy to guide other members of your organization in creating their own accounts.
  Video tutorial: How to create an account as the coordinator
- [ ] Look for an invitation to our live training workshop and plan to attend (please RSVP "yes" even if you cannot attend so that the recording can be sent to you automatically). Invite your volunteers to join you. We will be going over:
  - What to expect when your fair dates get closer
  - Using the website to get the most out of your fair
  - Reviewing best practices for promoting your fair
- [ ] Inside your **School Hub** (on your Ignatius Book Fairs account), edit the names of the classrooms and add any additional active classrooms. Use the invite feature to invite teachers to their classrooms.
  Resource: How to invite teachers to their classrooms
- [ ] Send an email to teachers letting them know to look for the invitation, and to follow the prompts to create their own accounts, claim their classrooms, choose titles for reading recommendations for their students, and choose titles for a wish list of books they would like for their classrooms.
  Video: Features for Teachers

Advertising Your Fair

- [ ] Ensure the **date, times, and location** of your fair are posted on the **school or parish calendar**. Be as descriptive as space allows.
- [ ] Ensure you have a **dedicated volunteer** who will post about the fair on social media and in other community outlets
- [ ] If you are connected to a parish, check the deadline for bulletin ads. Submit your ad in time so it is published directly before your fair begins. Prepare the ad early.

Sample Advertising Schedule

- [ ] **6 Weeks Out** – Post a Save the Date announcement including dates and your school's online shopping link
- [ ] **5 Weeks Out** – Share what makes Ignatius Book Fairs special
- [ ] **4 Weeks Out** – Post another reminder about the fair dates with this graphic
- [ ] **15 Days Out** – Use the parent letter template to craft a letter announcing the book fair dates. Have the principal or pastor send it to families 1 week before the fair opens. Also share the Sneak Peek catalog.
- [ ] **1 Week Out** – If you ordered a box of sample books, it should be arriving now! Plan where you will display the materials — an area with high foot-traffic is best.
- [ ] **Night Before Opening** – Share a quick sneak peek of some titles you are excited about. Remind your community about when the fair opens and how to shop online.

During the Fair (Daily Posts)

- [ ] **Day 1:** Kick off by introducing the Family Reading Challenge to your school families
- [ ] **Day 2:** Post on social media: "We are on day 2 of our week-long virtual book fair. All purchases help us reach our goal of getting new books for the library and classrooms. Free shipping to our school is available during the fair dates." Share your school's online ordering link.
- [ ] **Day 3:** "Have you checked out our online book fair yet? If you are unsure what books might be a good fit for your child, there are reading recommendations by age and grade level. Your child's teacher may have recommendations and a wish list too!"
- [ ] **Day 4:** Share your staff's top 5 picks of books that are fun, interesting, and thought-provoking. Consider posting a picture of the teacher who recommended each title.
- [ ] **Day 5:** Encourage a "Stop, Drop and Read" habit — 20 minutes of daily family reading time. This can be a morning devotion, a few pages in a family book, or independent reading as part of the evening routine. When children see reading modeled at home, it fosters a love of reading.
- [ ] **Day 6:** "Tomorrow is the last day of our online book fair and we want to thank everyone who has ordered so far! If you have book recommendations for other parents, please share them below."
- [ ] **Day 7:** "Today is the last day to place an order while our fair is still open. Your purchases earn us 30% of the net sale back to spend on free books for our school. Please get your orders in by tonight. We appreciate you!"

Logistics to Consider

(Within 3 Weeks of Opening)

- [ ] Print Virtual Student Wish Lists and give to each child in PreK–8th grade. Allow time in the week leading up to the virtual fair for children to look online and fill out their wish list.
- [ ] Consider creating simple **stick-on labels** for PreK–3rd grade that can go on uniforms at dismissal the day before the fair opens to remind parents about the fair dates/times. This will be the last reminder before the fair starts, but not the last way to keep families engaged.

- [ ] Ensure you have enough **change on hand** to handle any cash sales
  Recommended: $200 in smaller bills and $30 in assorted coins
- [ ] Have a **secure cash box** (or similar solution) ready to organize cash and checks
- [ ] Order or gather **shopping bags** for customer purchases. Examples:
  - TRADITIONAL PLASTIC BAG
  - BIODEGRADABLE SHOPPING BAG
  - PAPER SHOPPING BAG EXAMPLE
- [ ] **Decor (optional)**: If you'd like to add beyond what is provided, consider balloons, twinkle lights, or streamers
  Tip: This is a good time to order or request donations for these items
- [ ] As soon as your books and materials arrive (approximately 1 week before the fair), take out the **Sneak Peek flyers** and send one home with each family along with a letter with the dates and times for shopping.

Set-Up (After Your Books Are Delivered)

- [ ] Find the box marked "**Open First**" and plug in the **payment devices** and **external credit card readers** so they can fully charge
- [ ] Find the **Marketing Kit** and place the **tablecloths** on the tables
- [ ] Locate the **5 posters** (in the bottom of one of the marketing boxes) and hang them on the walls
- [ ] Use the **table category signs** to mark where specific categories of books will be displayed. Set out **2–3 metal book stands** on each table.
- [ ] Check the **packing slips** on the boxes to identify which category of books is inside. Sort the boxes by placing them in front of the tables where they will be displayed.
- [ ] Log in to the **payment device** using your organization's **unique PIN** (sent via email 8 days before your fair begins)
- [ ] Scan the **packing slips** on the outside of the merchandise boxes to load all inventory into the payment device. *Do not scan boxes containing set-up materials.*
- [ ] Set up the books on the tables and store the empty boxes — they will be needed for **returns after the fair ends**

If you get stuck or have questions, please contact us at 888-771-2321.